

Commercial Risks

The risks to winning and keeping customers — and how to blunt them.

Pack 19 — Risk Management

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Document	Commercial Risks
Purpose	Detail market/competitive/revenue risks with concrete mitigations.
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BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

The commercial risks are competition, slow adoption, and CAC uncertainty. Each is mitigated by the same disciplines already built into the plan: a focused segment, a free-trial motion, and CAC-gated spend. The plan is designed to fail cheaply and learn fast, not to bet big on unproven assumptions.

Detailed commercial risks

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Payaca/Reonic out-compete or out-spend	Lost deals, higher CAC	Compete on focus + price wedge + speed, not spend (Pack 04); own the small-installer segment they underserve
Slow adoption (installers stay on spreadsheets)	Long sales cycles	Lead with cost-of-status-quo pitch; free trial removes risk (Pack 09)
CAC higher than assumed	Model breaks	CAC-gated paid spend (Pack 07); free MCS channel keeps blended CAC low (Pack 08)
UK pricing set too high (kills wedge)	Lost differentiation	Model the trade-off explicitly (Pack 16); pricing is an early CEO agenda item
First references slow to materialise	Credibility gap persists	Prioritise first 2–3 UK case studies on preferential terms (Pack 09)

THE STRUCTURAL MITIGATION

Most commercial risk is contained by one design choice: **a lean, low-burn operation that starts with a free lead channel and gates spend on proven conversion.** This means the downside of being wrong about the market is small — you learn cheaply rather than burning capital on an unproven thesis.

Implication

Commercial risk is real but bounded by design. The single biggest lever to reduce it further is getting the first UK references fast — which is why it recurs as a priority across Packs 05, 07 and 09.

Sources & confidence

Claim	Source	Confidence
Competitor dynamics	Pack 04	 / 
CAC/adoption	—	 Validate with pilot